

Your half — the studio

You are Jon Shipp, Chordential. You run the call.

A Chordential discovery call · HALVARD, “Long Way Home”
· agency: Pike & Rowan.

Every name and brand here is invented. Nothing in this call describes real client work.

HOW TO RUN IT

1. Two readers, one script each. **Both are numbered the same**, and the other person's lines are printed so you never lose your place.
2. Schedule the call in Chordential so the notetaker joins, then start the Zoom.
3. **Read at talking pace, not reading pace.** Pause, overlap, say “um”. It is being tested against speech — a flat recitation tests nothing that matters.
4. About **10–12 minutes**. Don't rush the read-back near the end; it is doing real work.

1 · YOU

Marisa, thanks for making time. Before we start — who's with us today, and how does each of you touch this project?

2 · MARISA

Just me today. I'm Marisa Del Rio, senior producer at Pike & Rowan. I'm running production on this one end to end.

3 • YOU

And who isn't here who has an opinion on the music?

4 • MARISA

Our creative director, Aziz Barr. And someone on the HALVARD side will have to bless it, but that's later.

5 • YOU

I've got a notetaker running so I'm listening rather than typing. Is that alright with you?

Say this OUT LOUD every time. It is the consent line, and a recording nobody agreed to is worth less than no recording.

6 • MARISA

That's fine.

7 • YOU

I'll ask about the work, the sound, the plan, and then some boring commercial questions at the end. You'll have a written summary today. Does that work?

8 • MARISA

Works. I've got about forty minutes.

9 • YOU

Before the music — what is this campaign trying to do for the business?

10 • MARISA

HALVARD has been a technical outdoor brand for twenty years and it reads as cold. This is the autumn brand film, and the job is to make people feel something about the brand rather than about the jacket. If we get it right, it shifts how people talk about them.

11 • YOU

And how will you know it worked?

12 • MARISA

Honestly? If the comments are about the film and not about the price.

13 • YOU

What is the music's job inside the film specifically?

14 • MARISA

It carries the whole thing. There's no voiceover and barely any dialogue — a woman walking home over about two minutes, the seasons changing around her. The music is the narration.

15 • YOU

Talk me through every version you need. Master, cutdowns, socials, stems.

16 • MARISA

A two-minute master for the film. Then thirty and fifteen second cutdowns for broadcast, and vertical versions for social.

17 • YOU

How many verticals, and do you need stems on all of them or just the master?

18 • MARISA

Three verticals. Stems just on the master — our editor likes to duck things himself.

TRAP 1 of 5 — she changes this to four verticals at turn 68. The summary must carry FOUR.

19 • YOU

Walk me through how it should feel across the piece, start to end.

20 • MARISA

It starts as almost nothing — one instrument, quite bare. It should feel like the cold. Then it warms, and by the last thirty seconds it's full and it lands somewhere hopeful. But not triumphant. Please, not triumphant.

21 • YOU

Is there a turn anywhere, or does it hold one feeling throughout?

22 • MARISA

There's a turn about eighty seconds in, when she reaches the ridge.

23 • YOU

What are you listening to for this? And is there anything you've been sent that's the wrong direction?

24 • MARISA

We've been living in Johannsson and Hildur Gudnadottir. Everyone keeps sending us Sigur Ros and it is the wrong direction — too weightless. And the temp track on the cut right now is a licensed indie thing that we all hate.

The DISAVOWED reference is the valuable half. Check the summary records what to avoid, not just what to chase.

25 • YOU

Which part of the Johannsson are you reacting to — the instrumentation, or the feeling?

26 • MARISA

The restraint. He leaves space.

27 • YOU

What is the air date, and when do you need final delivery to hit it?

28 • MARISA

It goes live October the third. We'd want final delivery three weeks before that, so around the twelfth of September.

Two DIFFERENT dates. If the summary collapses them into one, that is the schedule bug this question exists to catch.

29 • YOU

Are those the same date for everything, or do socials come later?

30 • MARISA

Socials can come a week after the master.

31 • YOU

**And is anything upstream of us still moving,
like the edit lock?**

32 • MARISA

*We lock picture on the twenty-second of August. That
should hold.*

33 • YOU

What is the approved number for music?

34 • MARISA

We're around sixty.

TRAP 2 — a soft number. Do NOT accept it; the
follow-up is the next line and it is what pins the real
one.

35 • YOU

**Is that all-in including the licence, and is it a
ceiling or a target?**

36 • MARISA

*The approved music number is fifty-five to sixty-five
thousand, and it is a hard ceiling. That's inclusive of the
licence.*

37 • YOU

**Who gives final approval on this, and how
many times will they see it?**

38 • MARISA

*Aziz signs off creatively. He'll see it twice — a first pass
and a final.*

39 • YOU

Is anyone else in the room whose opinion changes the outcome?

40 • MARISA

Sorry — I should correct myself. Aziz signs off on our side, but final approval is Tom Vasquez, HALVARD's brand director. He sees it once, at the end.

TRAP 3, and the important one. TWO answers to 'who signs off'. Campaign Intelligence should surface the conflict rather than silently keeping whichever it heard last.

41 • YOU

That's worth having straight. So Aziz is our day-to-day, and Tom is the one who can send it back?

42 • MARISA

Yes. And Tom is not a music person, so make it obvious.

43 • YOU

Tell me how the brand shows up. What is it careful about?

44 • MARISA

They're careful about anything that reads as luxury — they're a working brand. And music has let them down before. They licensed something two years ago that turned up in a car ad three months later, and it was embarrassing.

45 • YOU

How does your side actually work — who moves paper, and how fast?

46 • MARISA

Our legal is slow. Assume three weeks for any contract. And procurement will want a purchase order before anything starts.

47 • YOU

Right — the boring bit. Where does the music actually run — broadcast, digital, social?

48 • MARISA

Broadcast and social. No cinema, and no out-of-home.

The fourth priced lever, and the one the sheet never used to ask. Organic social and all-media-including-cinema are nearly three times apart.

49 • YOU

Is that the whole plan, or is there a phase two?

50 • MARISA

There's talk of cinema at Christmas, but nothing booked.

Another UNCOMMITTED extension, like the UK one at turn 54. It must not be priced as agreed.

51 • YOU

Noted — I'll scope what's booked. How long do you need the usage to run?

52 • MARISA

Twelve months from first air, I think.

53 • YOU

Is that from delivery, or from first air?

54 • MARISA

From first air.

55 • YOU

When that term is up, do you expect to renew, or does it lapse?

56 • MARISA

I'd expect we renew if it performs. Can we agree the renewal price now?

57 • YOU

We can, and it is cheaper to. Where does this run — US only, or worldwide?

58 • MARISA

North America to start. There's a chance it extends to the UK in the spring, but that is not committed.

An UNCOMMITTED extension is not a territory. It should read as a possibility, never priced as if agreed.

59 • YOU

Do you need any exclusivity, category or otherwise?

60 • MARISA

Category exclusive for outdoor apparel, for the term. That one is non-negotiable after what happened.

61 • YOU

Is there an expectation about who holds publishing?

62 • MARISA

I genuinely don't know. I'd have to ask legal.

TRAP 4 — a question ASKED but not answered. It must land as an open question, never as a captured fact. This is the state Phase 1 calls 'raised'.

63 • YOU

That's fine — I'll put a standard position in the summary and your legal can push back. Will this need PRO registration, and do you have a cue sheet process?

64 • MARISA

Yes, we file cue sheets. Our post house handles it.

65 • YOU

What does your payment schedule usually look like?

66 • MARISA

Net sixty from invoice.

67 • YOU

Is there a deposit, and what triggers the final invoice?

68 • MARISA

We can do a deposit on signature. Final on delivery and acceptance.

69 • YOU

Any requirement about union or non-union players?

70 • MARISA

No requirement. We've used live players before and liked it.

71 • YOU

One more thing — you said three verticals earlier. Is that still right?

72 • MARISA

Actually, make it four. There's a fourth placement we just picked up.

TRAP 1 lands here. Scope moved mid-call. If the summary still says three, the deal is under-scoped before it starts.

Noted — four verticals. Let me play back what I've got, and stop me where I'm wrong. Two-minute master; thirty and fifteen second cutdowns; four verticals; stems on the master only. Live October third, final delivery September twelfth, picture lock August twenty-second. Fifty-five to sixty-five all-in, hard ceiling. Twelve months from first air, North America, category exclusive in outdoor apparel. Net sixty with a deposit on signature. Tom Vasquez approves, Aziz day to day. Publishing still open.

The read-back is the cheapest moment to catch a wrong number, and it is the line most often skipped when a call runs long.

That's all right. One correction — the fifteen second cutdown might become a six. I'll confirm.

TRAP 5 — a correction arriving DURING the read-back, which is exactly what the read-back is for.

I'll scope both and we'll drop one. What haven't I asked about that I should have?

76 • MARISA

*Whether you need the stems by instrument or by group.
Group is fine.*

77 • YOU

Good catch — that's a real difference. Has anything gone wrong on a project like this before?

78 • MARISA

The car ad thing. And once we got a track that was beautiful and forty seconds too short to cut down.

79 • YOU

You'll get a written summary today. Who else should be on it?

80 • MARISA

Copy Aziz. Not Tom yet.

81 • YOU

And what's the best way to reach you if something needs a quick answer?

82 • MARISA

Email, or my mobile — it's in my signature.

83 • YOU

Thanks Marisa. This was a good one.

84 • MARISA

Thanks Jon.

What this call is engineered to break

Five deliberate traps, in the order they arrive. Each is a real failure this system has had or could have. The exercise is checking the summary catches them — not checking the transcript is tidy.

URNS 18 → 68

Three verticals quietly becomes four, forty turns later.

The summary must scope FOUR. Three means the deal is under-scoped before it starts.

URNS 34 → 36

“We’re around sixty” — a soft number.

Must land as \$55–65k, hard ceiling, licence inclusive. Never “around 60”.

URNS 38 → 40

Two answers to who signs off — Aziz, then Tom Vasquez.

The conflict has to surface. Silently keeping whichever was heard last is the bug.

URN 58

Publishing is asked and NOT answered.

It must survive as an open question, never a captured fact. Evidence or nothing.

TURN 70

A correction arrives during the read-back.

The “:15 may become :06” caveat has to reach the summary.

TWO MORE, EASY TO LOSE

- **Turn 28 gives two different dates** — air October 3rd, delivery September 12th. A summary that collapses them into one has made the schedule mistake the timeline question exists to prevent.
- **Turn 54 is an uncommitted extension** to the UK. It must read as a possibility. Priced as agreed territory, the quote is wrong in the client's favour and we eat it.

EXPECTED SCORE

This script asks **every question on the sheet**, which makes the run a control with a known answer. Scored against the script text, Phase 1 returns:

25 of 25 covered — everything came up.

So the prep page should read **25 of 25 covered**. Less than that is a finding:

- **A line comes back missed that you know you asked.**
Suspect the transcript first — read what the notetaker actually heard. Only if the words are plainly there is it a gap in the cue bank.
- **A line comes back covered that you know you skipped.**
That is a false tick, and it is the failure that matters, because

it manufactures confidence. Note the sentence it printed as evidence; that sentence is the fix.

THE NUMBER ACTUALLY WORTH READING

Not the headline — the **answered / raised** split. Ten of the twenty-five lines are Campaign Intelligence slots; the other fourteen are conversation and can only ever read *raised*. So watch the “**Asked, but nothing stuck**” line. Every slot on it was asked on this call and you have the script to prove it, which makes each one a clean extraction failure with the right answer sitting in the transcript.